

ALU Senate's Research Ethics Committee (REC)
African Leadership University
Kigali, Rwanda

Date: 22nd June 2026
Attn: Thierry SHYAKA

Ethics Approval for Research Project [Approval Code: M26-BSE-068]

I am pleased to inform you that your request for ethics clearance for your project has been approved on behalf of the Ethics in Research Committee. This approval is in effect for the next 6 months of the dating of this letter.

Take Note:

1. Any changes in procedure with regards to the nature and extent of interactions with human subjects should be communicated to the Ethics in Research Committee within 48 hours of such changes being made via email.
2. Significant changes in topic, guiding questions and methodology will require a re-application for ethics clearance.
3. This approval is only effective while the users of the approval are still staff and/or partners with the African Leadership University.

While conducting fieldwork, kindly **adhere to the following ethical guidelines:**

- Consent needs to be obtained from all study participants unless they are minors and in which case consent should be obtained from legal guardians before data collection;
- Obtain consent before audio or/and video recording of study participants. Also obtain permission before taking photographs (especially) up-close.
- Study participants and their contributions should always be protected and the goal of the study as well as how their data will be used should be clearly communicated to the study participants;
- Protect the identity of participants in vulnerable situations; preferably in all situations;
- Respect the confidentiality of study participants and;
- Avoid promissory style or any form of coercing for data, do not offer rewards for participation.

We implore you to maintain the highest level of ethical behavior during and after your data collection exercise. If you have any questions or requests do not hesitate to contact us.

Kindest regards,



Venuste Niyonzima
ALU's Research Ethics Committee Chairperson

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